Lesson plan · for the teacher

What its tools allow

AI agents · Level 1 · Lesson 2

Time
40 min

Materials
Six tool cards per group: Timetable, Weather, Calculator, Library, Reminder, Message; About ten request cards (some a tool can do, some no tool can do, some with a detail missing); The class timetable on the board

Learning goals

- Explain that an agent acts only through its tools.
- Say what a good agent does when a tool is off, missing, or a detail is missing.
- Choose which tools to give an agent for a job.

Activity: The toolbox

1. Warm-up (5 min): Hold up a calculator (or draw one). Ask: what can it do, and what can it never do, however hard you press? Link this to tools: each one does one job.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain that an agent reads the request and the list of tools that are on, and fills in the details each tool needs. Write the four outcomes on the board: uses a tool, says it's off, says "I can't", asks for a detail.
3. The toolbox (15 min): Each group has six tool cards. Read a request card aloud. Groups hold up a tool card, ask for the missing detail, or say "I can't". Award a point for each good decision, and two for a good question.
4. Tool off (7 min): Each group turns one card face down: that tool is switched off. Read three more requests. Praise groups that say "that tool is off" instead of using another card to fake it.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Ask: if a real agent helped with the library, which tools should it have, and which should stay off? Then give the exit ticket.

Prepare six tool cards per group and about ten request cards: four a tool can do, three no tool can do, three with a detail missing. Paper and pens are enough.

Discussion

- Why is "I can't" sometimes the best answer an agent can give?
- What could go wrong if an agent guessed a missing detail?
- Which tools would you never switch on for an agent at school, and why?

Exit ticket

- Write one request a tool can do, one no tool can do, and one with a detail missing.

Try it in class tomorrow
Play "The toolbox": groups get six tool cards, and you read out requests. For each one they decide: use a tool, ask for a missing detail, or say "I can't". Then turn one card face down (the tool is off) and play again.

Worksheet · for pupils

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **You ask "What's the weather tomorrow?" and the agent replies "Which village?". Why?**

◯ It is broken ◯ It has never heard of any village

◯ The weather tool needs a place, and you gave none

2 **Match each request to what a good agent does.**

"What's the weather in Kafi tomorrow?" (weather tool on)	• • • •	Says none of its tools can help
"Book a bus ticket to the city."	• • • •	Says the reminder tool is off
"What's the weather tomorrow?"	• • • •	Calls the weather tool with Kafi and tomorrow
"Remind me at 8:00." (reminder tool off)	• • • •	Asks which village

3 **If no tool on its list fits a job, a good agent should find some other way to do the job anyway.**

◯ True ◯ False

4 **The weather tool needs a place and a day. Which requests give the agent everything it needs? Choose all that apply.**

☐ What's the weather tomorrow? ☐ Is it hot there? ☐ Will it rain in Kafi on Monday?

☐ What's the weather in Dala tomorrow?

5 **Complete the sentences.**

An agent acts only through its _____. When the tool it needs is off, a good agent should _____. When a detail is missing, it should _____.

Word bank: say so · guess · users · tools · ask · pretend

Answers · for the teacher

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1 **The weather tool needs a place, and you gave none**

A detail the tool needs was missing, so it asked instead of guessing.

2 **"What's the weather in Kafi tomorrow?" (weather tool on) — Calls the weather tool with Kafi and tomorrow**
"Book a bus ticket to the city." — Says none of its tools can help
"What's the weather tomorrow?" — Asks which village
"Remind me at 8:00." (reminder tool off) — Says the reminder tool is off

A request a tool can do gets a call; a job no tool covers gets "I can't"; a missing detail gets a question; a tool that's off gets an honest "it's off".

3 **False**

An agent can act only through its tools.

4 **What's the weather in Dala tomorrow?; Will it rain in Kafi on Monday?**

Dala tomorrow and Kafi on Monday each give a place and a day.

5 **An agent acts only through its tools. When the tool it needs is off, a good agent should say so. When a detail is missing, it should ask.**

Tools are the only way an agent acts. Saying a tool is off and asking for a missing detail keep you informed; guessing and pretending hide mistakes.

For you to think about

Think of a job you might give an agent at your school. Which tools would you switch on, and which would you leave off on purpose?